

HOUSE No. 591

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Danielle W. Gregoire

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act relative to school bullying.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Danielle W. Gregoire</i>	<i>4th Middlesex</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 591

By Representative Gregoire of Marlborough, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 591) of Danielle W. Gregoire relative to school bullying. Education.

[SIMILAR MATTER FILED IN PREVIOUS SESSION
SEE HOUSE, NO. 3754 OF 2023-2024.]

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act relative to school bullying.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 SECTION 1. Section 1B of chapter 69 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2022
2 Official Edition, is hereby amended by adding the following paragraph:-

3 The board shall see to it that all schools provide the board with a copy of the updated plan
4 to address bullying prevention and intervention under subsection (d) of section 37O of chapter
5 71. In the event of noncompliance, the board and the commissioner may use all powers
6 established under this section to ensure schools provide the board with a copy of the updated
7 plan under said subsection (d) of said section 37O.

8 SECTION 2. Paragraph (1) of subsection (d) of section 37O of chapter 71 of the General
9 Laws, as so appearing , is hereby amended by striking out the third and fourth sentences and
10 inserting in place thereof the following 2 sentences:- The consultation shall include, but not be

11 limited to: (i) notice that shall be posted, with a draft copy of the updated plan, in a conspicuous
12 place or places on the school's premises and on the school's website; (ii) a public comment
13 period that shall accept written comments on the updated plan, submitted by any interested
14 person, within 30 days of the posted notice; provided, however, that a non-public school shall
15 only be required to give notice to and provide a comment period for families that have a child
16 attending the school; and (iii) if no plan is currently in place, prior to the development of the plan
17 there shall be a public comment period accepting written comments on the development of the
18 original plan, submitted by any interested person and upon completion of the original plan the
19 school shall follow the steps in clauses (i) and (ii). The school shall consider all relevant
20 comments and suggestions before finalizing the plan and subsequent updates to the plan. The
21 plan shall be updated every 2 years and a copy of the updated plan shall be submitted to the
22 board within 30 days of the completed updates.

23 SECTION 3. Said section 37O of said chapter 71, as so appearing, is hereby further
24 amended by inserting after the word "retaliation", in line 272, the following words:- , including
25 incidents that result in students being suspended or expelled.

26 SECTION 4. Subsection (n) of said section 37O of said chapter 71, as so appearing, is
27 hereby further amended by striking out the first sentence and inserting in place thereof the
28 following sentence:- The department shall investigate certain alleged incidents of bullying,
29 within a 2 year period of the alleged incidents.